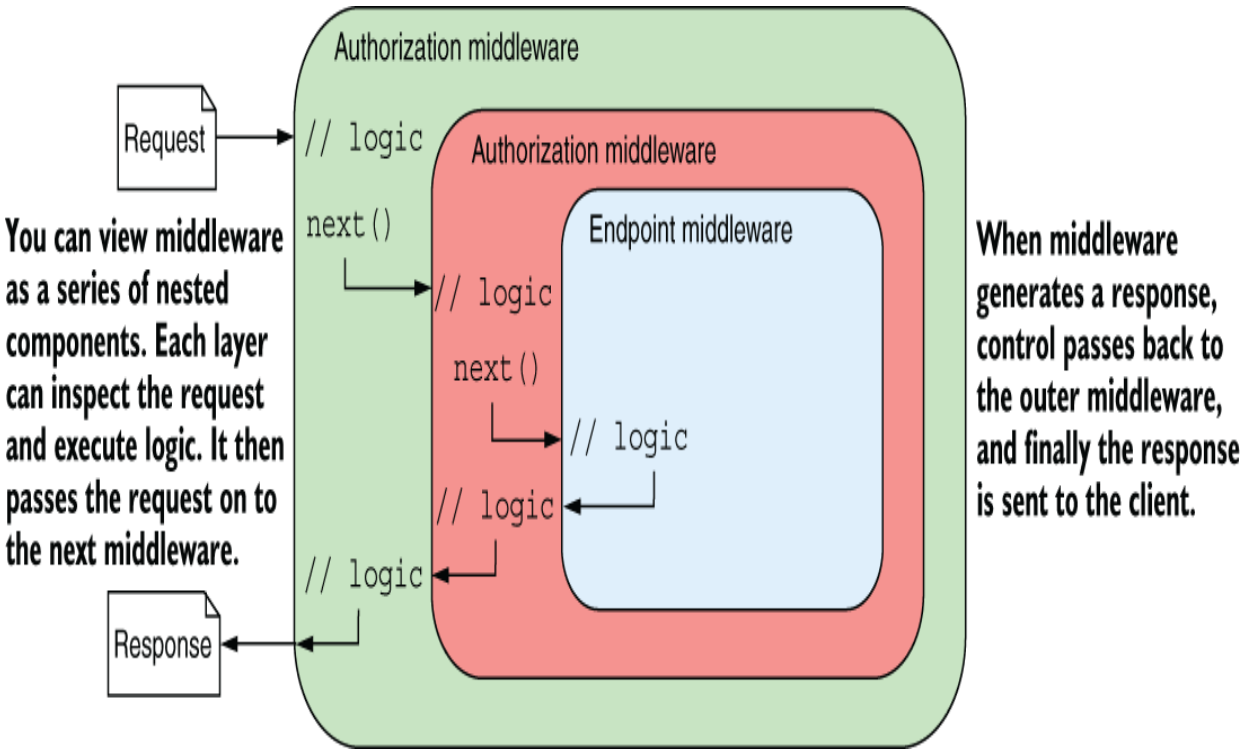


Figure 4.3 You can also think of middleware as being a series of nested components; a request is sent deeper into the middleware, and the response resurfaces from it. Each middleware component can execute logic before passing the response on to the next middleware component and can execute logic after the response has been created, on the way back out of the stack.

Middleware vs. HTTP modules and HTTP handlers

In the previous version of ASP.NET, the concept of a middleware pipeline isn't used. Instead, you have HTTP modules and HTTP handlers.

An *HTTP handler* is a process that runs in response to a request and generates the response. The ASP.NET page handler, for example, runs in response to requests for .aspx pages. Alternatively, you could write a custom handler that returns resized images when an image is requested.